Global Cities Initiative: Transform World 2009

New York City, September 9-11, 2009



A Call to Cultivate a New Culture for our City, by Luis Bush

A Call to Cultivate a New Culture for our City

I. Context – time & place of the call . .

II. Commentary of Scripture

III. Considerations – re the Call . . .

IV. Carrying out the Call . . .

I. The Context – Place

- Globalization
- Powerful cultural forming in major spheres of society
- Interconnectivity to Emerging Christianity
- Post-modern Culture
- Mega challenge of our time

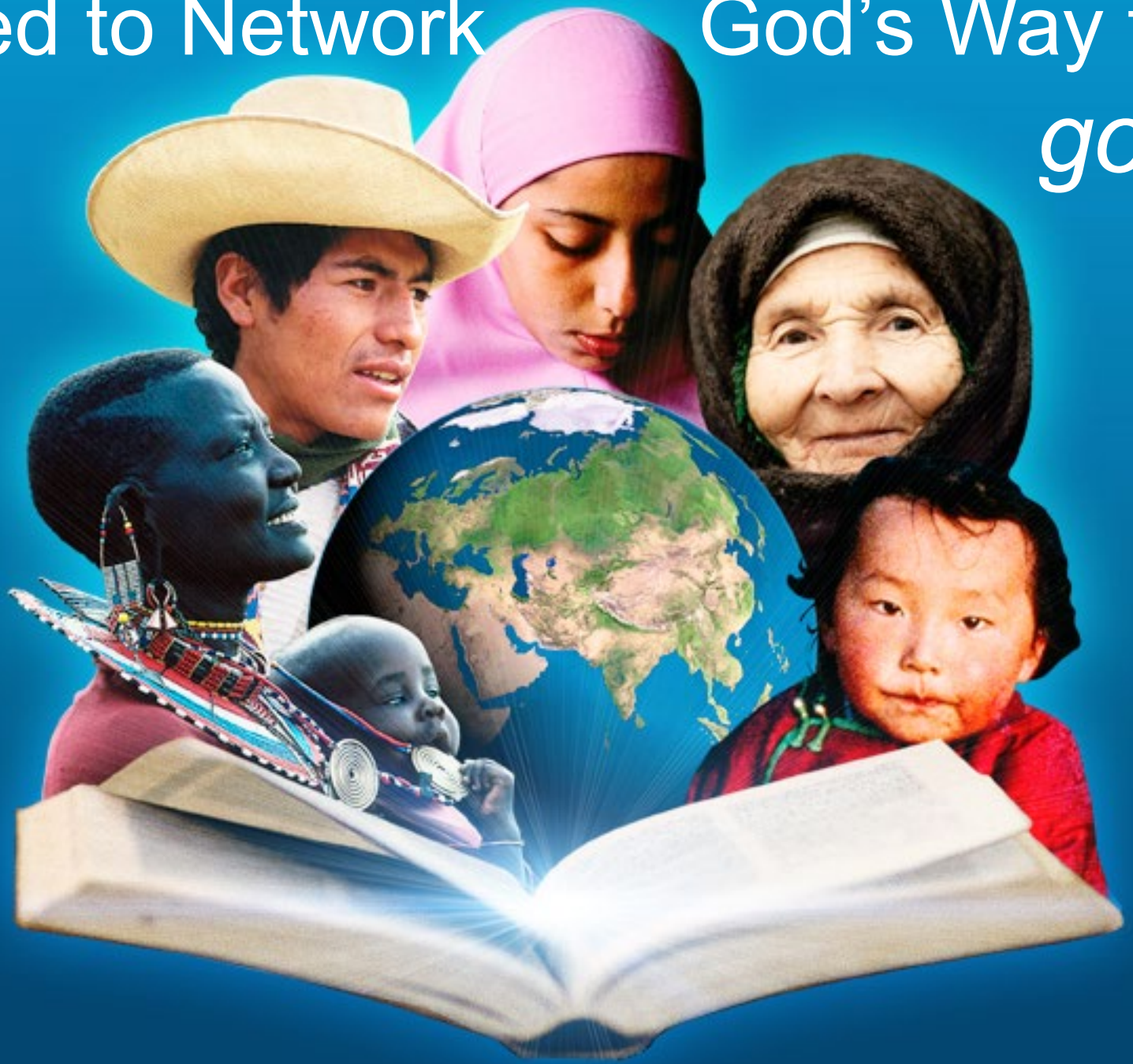
The Power of Networking





Before For Evil After

Need to Network God's Way for *good*



Biblical Revelation on Networking for Good

"Under his direction, the whole body is fitted together perfectly. As each part does its own special work, it helps the other parts grow, so that the whole body is healthy and growing and full of love" (Eph 4:16)

Networking=A healthy body = SUNARMOLOGEO

Literally means to join with the others by choice

To have a healthy body of believers we need to network to have an appropriate vibrant & visible presence

***sun,* with *harmos,* a joint *lego,* to choose**

God has already knit us together.
… just use it

I. The Call Context – Time

- Place – Why New York?
- Time – What 9-11 Teaches Us?

  The Power of Networks

II. Commentary of Scripture

- "When Israel is in exile it is paradigmic for us. It's crucial for us," Tim Keller
- Ezekiel is a biblical case for a *Global City Initiative*
- Ezekiel shows that "it takes a movement of the Holy Spirit to renew the city," Tim Keller
- Ezekiel describes the *nature of city renewal*
- Ezekiel defines a renewed city as *a Shalom community* Ez. 37:25-27

II. Commentary of Scripture

- "Difference Between Ezekiel and Our Time
- What Ezekiel portrays as the *End Goal*, we seek to model and introduce on the way to getting there
- *Shalom community* – 4 Related Indicators

  Economic → Eradication of Poverty

  Spiritual → Presence of God

  Political → Justice for all

  Social → Relational Harmony

II. Commentary of Scripture

Acts 17:1-9

- People Drawn → Jews, Gentiles, women 1-4
- BUT Others Repelled → Persecution 5-9
- Point: Some Drawn, Others Repelled →

Culture Is Transformed Yet in Tension

II. Commentary of Scripture

1 Peter 2:11-17

- We Are in Exile
- We Are To Be Faithful
- We Need To Be Prepared To Be Maligned,
- Our Call Is To Show God's Goodness and Character

III. Consideration – Views of Relationship between Christ & Culture

- ***Christ Against Culture*** – Tertullian, Tolstoy, Menno Simons
- ***Christ of Culture*** – Liberation theology
- ***Christ Above Culture*** – Luther
- ***Christ the Transformer of Culture*** – Augustine, Calvin, John Wesley, and Jonathan Edwards

How Church Engages Culture

- Christ accomplishes this transformation through the church at large
- The body of Christ reflects God's presence & principles showing God's love & challenging the culture.
- The culture is either drawn or repels the challenge
- The key for the Church is that she be faithful

IV. Carrying out the Call . . .

An ecosystem is a community functioning with related parts operating as a unit.

Vibrant

1. Movement of Reproducing churches
2. Alliances of Prayer to Intercede for the City
3. Reaching & Raising up 4/14 Window Golden Age of Opportunity & Youth
4. Presence in all Spheres of Cultural Influence
5. Compassion & Love in Action

ECOSYSTEM

Visible

6. Collaboration of Laity & Clergy
7. Personal and Corporate Renewal

Renewing the City

Vibrancy & visibility represent a presence that cannot be ignored by the larger culture

Two Tipping Points

1. Emergence of leadership churches
2. Final tipping point – when it reaches 5% to 10% vital Christians in the city *it changes the culture of the city*

II. The Call – Nature of

The Global City Initiative to fill the gap . . .

"I looked for a man among them who would build up the wall and stand before me in the gap on behalf of the land so I would not have to destroy it, but I found none" (Ezek 22:30)